Union and her allies that the Secretary-General was acting on behalf of the United States and its friends against the Communist states, and they vetoed his nomination for a further term in February 1951. Though the veto was later revoked and he continued his office without a re-election, ultimately he earned the undying criticisms of the USA too for allowing the 'pro-Communist' Americans to work in the Secretariat. Lie finally resigned at the end of 1952 before his extended term expired.[16]

Dag Hammarskjöld (Sweden), the second Secretary-General, was more cautious in his approach. He embarked on what came to be known as "preventive diplomacy" through conciliation and good offices in many situations. He proved his worth in his conciliatory endeavours using his good offices and personal contact with Zhou En-lai (1898–1976), the Chinese Premier, and secured the release of US airmen from China who were imprisoned there in 1955. Thereafter, he played a commending role in the Suez Crisis and the Lebanon Crisis followed by the organization of an observer force in Lebanon in 1958. In 1960, during the Congo Crisis, Dag invoked the powers of the Secretary-General under Article 99 of the Charter and requested a meeting of the Security Council and creation of ONUC and recommended the withdrawal of Belgian troops from Congo. But these were accepted by the Security Council and he was authorized to provide military assistance as he felt necessary. However, the growing role of the Secretary-General was not liked by the Soviet Union and they came up with a proposal known as the **Troika Plan** whereby, instead of one Secretary-General, there would be three Secretaries-General—one from a Western, another from a Communist, and yet another from a neutral country. However, Dag Hammarskjöld died in a plane crash on his way to a personal visit to Tsombe **(President of Katanga)** in his bid to resolve the Congo crisis.

U Thant (Burma, now Myanmar), succeeded Dag as the third Secretary-General. He played a similar kind of role as that of Dag and tried to expand the concept of preventive diplomacy. He played a crucial role during the Cuban Missile Crisis. He also played an effective role in the Congo and Cyprus crises. However, his Vietnam venture could not succeed due to American intransigence and he